

MSc Computer Science graduate from Newcastle University with backend experience across Laravel/PHP and Java/Spring Boot: RESTful APIs, relational data models, and service-layer architecture. Experienced across the full stack, including React frontends, MySQL/PostgreSQL/Elasticsearch, and real-time and payment integrations, with a track record of shipping projects end-to-end, including a live marketplace handling real transactions.

EXPERIENCE

Web Developer Infinity Fitness Gym & Sports Medicine Clinic

July 2026 – Present

North-East · Sole developer, direct client work

- Built and shipped a responsive site for a family-run gym, working with the owner from requirements to launch.
- Designed a self-service Join flow that generates a unique standing order reference per member, so the gym can match bank payments to a person and plan with no per-transaction fees.
- Built a browser-based tool that parses CSV and PDF bank statements client-side with pdf.js, flagging lapsed standing orders and outdated prices without data leaving the device.

EDUCATION

Newcastle University

Sept 2025 – Sept 2026

MSc Computer Science, Newcastle upon Tyne, UK

- Grade: Distinction
- Advanced Programming, Software Engineering & Team Project, Database Systems, Web Technologies, Computer Networks, Cybersecurity, AI Fundamentals & Responsible Innovation, Human-Computer Interaction.

Newcastle University

Sept 2022 – Aug 2025

BA (Hons) Contemporary Music, Newcastle upon Tyne, UK

PROJECTS

Restrum Online Instrument Marketplace

May 2026 – Aug 2026

North-East · [restrum.uk](#)

- Designed a relational schema of 10+ entities (User, Listing, ListingMedia, Instrument, Passport, Conversation, Message, SavedListing, UserEndorsement, UserFollow) covering marketplace listings, buyer-seller messaging, and an instrument provenance (“passport”) history feature.
- Built a Laravel / PHP REST API with Sanctum auth, real-time buyer-seller messaging over Reverb (WebSockets), and Stripe Connect for split marketplace payments.
- Elasticsearch-backed listing search with custom analyzers for prefixes, slang and model numbers, roughly 3x faster than the SQL path it replaced, with an automatic fallback when the cluster is unreachable.
- React 19 / TypeScript frontend; deployed via Docker Compose to a VPS behind Cloudflare, with CI running PHPUnit and Pint.

StaticGrind Browser-Based Glitch Art Tool

May 2026 – Aug 2026

North-East · [staticgrind.com](#)

- Built and shipped a live browser-based glitch art generator (React + Vite) with a hybrid WebGL/Canvas 2D rendering pipeline for real-time image, video, and webcam effects, including client-side video export to over 200 users.

Seedle Gardening Swap & Planning Platform (Solo Project)

Sept 2026

North-East · Solo project · [github.com/lewisr23/Seedle](#)

- Built a Laravel 13 / PHP 8.4 REST API with Sanctum auth and service classes for search, checkout and garden logic.
- Added Elasticsearch-backed faceted search with a plain-MySQL fallback, exercised directly by the test suite.
- Split checkout into a row-locked DB transaction and an async pipeline of Redis-queued jobs; 129 PHPUnit tests, Docker Compose across 8 services, GitHub Actions CI.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Backend:** Laravel, Spring Boot, Spring Security, Java, JPA/Hibernate, RESTful API design, service-layer architecture
- **Databases:** MySQL, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, Redis, relational schema design
- **Frontend:** React, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, SCSS
- **Languages:** PHP, Java, Python, JavaScript, SQL, HTML/CSS
- **Tools & Platforms:** Docker, Composer, Git, GitHub Actions (CI), PHPUnit, Maven, Vite, pdf.js, Google Cloud Platform (GCP), AWS
- **Core Concepts:** OOP, MVC, Agile, Authentication & Session Management, Concurrency, Distributed Systems

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Developer Associate (DVA-C02)
- CS50P: Introduction to Programming with Python, Harvard University (edX)